

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Sue Venir

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Sue Venir

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Your other secret

Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Mona Lott has obtained a copy of your original memo.
- Keep Dr. Art E. Fact from publicly speculating about your legal advice.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*
- 2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*
- 3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I issued a softer opinion after Grant rejected the original. Both versions survive. He wanted my name on his announcement and none of my qualifications in his speech. I am accustomed to clients ignoring advice. It is particularly irritating when they also demand that I sign the consequences.

IF MURDERER

The softer opinion bears my signature. Grant wanted to use it as permission for a permanent acquisition. My original described serious risk. He threatened to disclose both versions and let the profession decide which one I actually believed. He had purchased advice and expected immunity.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Our clerk sent the annex to conservation. I spent the whole exchange in the corridor, arguing through the west counter about whose initials belonged on the correction. The assistant fetched the folder and slid it back to me. That was all my business with preparation tonight. Grant still wanted the original legal opinion withdrawn. I kept it.

IF MURDERER

Our clerk sent the two opinions to conservation because the annex concerned the bowl's condition. I entered through the east visitor door and collected the corrected folder inside. Grant still wanted the original legal opinion withdrawn. I kept it. His secretary found an unsigned signature page on her desk afterward. Apparently silence requires legal advice too.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The folder has WEST RETURN written under my initials. I never crossed the barrier; the assistant did the fetching. Both opinions survived. Advice does not disappear simply because a client dislikes its first version.

IF MURDERER

The routing line says EAST VISITOR. I collected the folder from the shelves inside. Both opinions survived. Advice does not disappear simply because a client dislikes its first version.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Sue Venir

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Sue Venir

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I retained both opinions and let Grant believe the softer one had replaced the original. That was a professional compromise I intend to correct. My entire preparation visit stayed outside the west return barrier. The source shelves were on the other side. I could return an annex there; I could not remove the murder sample.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the walkthrough and concealed it in my spectacles cloth. I collected the unsigned signature page from the secretary's desk and brought it to Grant's open glass while the glass was uncovered. I coated its inside while he read, then left him to his private service. The lab found poison on the glass because that is where I put it. I cannot draft a qualification that excuses murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.